[METRIC]

A-A-2798
September 15, 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

LEAD, SYNTHETIC

The General Services Administration, Office Supplies & Paper Products Commodity Center, New York, NY 10278 has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This description covers leads to be used for general writing in appropriate mechanical pencils (lead holders).

I. Salient characteristics.

A. Composition. Leads shall be plastic based or polymer and shall produce uniformly dense, dark, opaque marks when used on paper. Marks shall be smudge resistant, and shall erase cleanly without ghosting when using a pencil type rubber eraser, artgum eraser or plastic film eraser.

B. Strength and Resilience. Leads shall be continuously smooth marking, and shall not crumble or chip, and shall be of such strength and resilience so as to reduce breakage when used properly.

C. Length of the Lead. The length of the lead shall be as required (see section VIII) with a tolerance of 2.0 mm. Length shall be in accordance with section II. (Units and numerical values are given in accordance with the International System of Units.)

D. Diameter of the Lead. The diameter of the lead shall be as required in the ordering information (see section VIII) with a tolerance of 0.02 mm. Diameter shall be in accordance with section II.

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

FSC 7510

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E. Hardness of the Lead. Hardness degree shall be marked on the leads.

The hardness range shall be expressed as a "grade" as defined by ASTM C709 and be one of the following, as specified:

10H, 9H, 8H, 7H, 6H, 5H, 4H, 3H, 2H, H, HB, B, 1B, 2B, 3B, 4B, 5B, 6B, 7B, 8B, 9B, 10B

The hardness of the leads shall such that no inversion shall take place as the density increases from 10B to 10H for the leads of the same brand. The grades and lack of inversions shall be certified by the vendor to be in conformance with normal commercial practice. The evidence of this conformance shall be available to the government in the form of a chart of line densities for the full range of grades, upon request.

F. Toxicity. The supplier shall certify that the leads contain no raw material that has ingredients of harmful substances and that the contents of lead, cadmium and arsenic shall be 200 ppm or less, each. As an alternative to the above certification, the Pencil Manufacturers Association Toxicity Certification shall be considered acceptable (see section VII). The harmful substances shall be defined as the poison and injurious substances as designated in Fed Std. 313.

G. Workmanship. Leads shall be clean and free from defects which adversely affect serviceability or performance. The container shall be in accordance with the manufacturers best commercial practice and shall have no defects that affect serviceability or appearance.

II. Measurements

A. Diameter. Measurements shall be taken at three points (near each end, and the middle) of each specimen. The mean of the three measurements shall determine the conformance of the sample.

B. Length. Measurements shall be made once per each sample selected, using a device with precision of at least 0.1 mm.

III. Recovered Materials.

The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, to the maximum extent practicable. The items shall be composed of the highest percentage of recovered materials practicable, consistent with maintaining a satisfactory level of competition without adversely affecting performance requirements or exposing suppliers' employees to undue hazards from the recovered materials.

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IV. Hazardous Material requirements.

A. Material safety data sheets. Safety data shall be furnished in accordance with Fed. Std. 313. The pertinent government mailing addresses for submission of data are listed in appendix B of Fed. Std. 313.

V. Quality assurance requirements.

A. Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see Ordering information), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier shall utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

B. Lot definition. Each lot shall be inspected for conformance to the requirements herein. Inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 using the sampling plans specified below. The lot shall be expressed in leads manufactured from the same materials at essentially the same time.

C. Examination of the end product for defects in workmanship. The sample unit for this examination shall be one filled unit container. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 2.5 % defective expressed in terms of percent defective in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

Examine	Defects
Workmanship	Not as specified
Material	Not as specified

D. Measurements. Inspection Level S-1 with an AQL of 2.5 percent defective, for each measurements. The sample unit shall be one lead.

Examine	Defects
Length	Not as specified
Diameter	Not as specified
Hardness	Not as specified

E. Packaging, Packing, and Marking. Inspection Level S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container inspected for conformance with the requirements of section VI.

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VI. Preparation for delivery.

A. Packaging, and Packing. Packaging, and packing shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order (see ordering information).

B. Marking. Packaging, packing, and marking shall be as indicated below, unless specified otherwise in the contract or purchase order (see ordering information).

For Shipment to Civil Agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123. Bar code marking is required, unless specified otherwise (See ordering information).

For Shipment to Military Activities. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Bar code marking is required, unless specified otherwise (See ordering information)

Additional Marking. The shipping containers shall include any precautionary marking required by the National Motor Freight Classification Item 222, Uniform Freight Classification Rule 41, and Department of Transportation regulations.

VII. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS.

The following documents, of the issues in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

A. American Society for Testing Materials (ASTM): ASTM standards are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

C 709 Standard definitions of terms relating to manufactured carbon and graphite.

B. Pencil Manufacturers Association (PMA): PMA standards and certifications are available from the Pencil Manufacturers Association, Two Greentree Center Suite 225, PO. Box 955, Marlton NJ 08053.

Pencil Manufacturers Association Toxicity Certification.

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C. Public Law and Code of Federal Regulations: Code of Federal Regulations and Federal Acquisition Regulations are for sale by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

Public Law 94-580 - Use of Recovered Materials
16 CFR Part 1500 - Federal Hazardous Substances Labeling Act.

D. National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc. Agent: Application for copies shall be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., 2200 Mil Rd., Alexandria, VA 22314.

National Motor Freight Classification

E. Uniform Classification Committee Agent: Application for copies shall be addressed to the National Railroad Freight Committee, Suite 1120, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, Illinois 60606.

Uniform Freight Classification
F. Federal Standards, Specifications, and Commercial Item Descriptions: Federal standards and specifications are available from GSA Business Service Centers and GSA Specification Unit (3FBP-W), 7th and D streets SW., Washington, D.C. 20407.

Single copies of this specification and other specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Auburn, Washington.

FED-STD-123 Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies)
FED-STD-313 Material Safety Data, Transportation Data and Disposal Data for Hazardous Materials Furnished to Government Activities.

G. Military Standards:
Military Standards are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk; Bldg. 4D; 700 Robbins Avenue; Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

MIL-STD-105 Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 Marking for Shipment and Storage.

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VIII. Notes.

A. Ordering information. Purchasers shall select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(1) Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
(2) Purchasers shall specify the length and diameter of the lead.
(3) Purchasers shall specify the degree of hardness.
(4) Purchasers shall specify arrangement for inspection and inspection facilities, if other than specified (see tests and quality assurance requirements.)
(5) Purchasers shall specify packaging and packing, any special marking for shipment required, if other than required (see preparation for delivery).
(6) Identification marking, if other than required.
(7) If bar code marking is not required.
(8) Purchasers shall specify palletization , if required.
(9) Purchasers shall specify any additional tests or salient characteristics, if required.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DOD has determined that no military activity has an official interest in this commercial item description.

Preparing Activity:
GSA-FSS

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